

Muncie Redevelopment Commission Meeting May 15th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sSKEIV58s1Y
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Municipal Meeting Analysis: Muncie Redevelopment Commission

Meeting Date: May 15, 2025

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Muncie Redevelopment Commission meeting to order on May 15, 2025.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Bishop, Mr. Dale, Mr. Miller, Mr. Pavilla, Miss Waggley, and Mr. Low (in audience).
 - **Absent:** None.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named by title, but acted as the meeting chair.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None noted in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:**

- A board member moved to approve the previous meeting memoranda with four specific additions/corrections (regarding a hotel update, affordable housing initiatives, the facade grant committee schedule, and clarifications on commissioner remarks).
- Following tied/contentious votes on the amended minutes, the board voted unanimously to table the approval of the previous meeting minutes to the next month as an action item.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:04:14 Claims Approval

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Wrights
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Wrights presented a short listing of claims, including a \$100,000 reallocation from Silver Birch to the 905 general fund, and noted \$450,000 previously approved and paid for street department paving materials. He also introduced a letter from WS Properties requesting \$246,130 for canal district operating expenses covering COVID-19 and supply chain-related deficits under an agreement from the previous administration.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Motion carried unanimously on roll call).

00:09:00 Director<U+2019>s Report & Project Updates

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Director Jeff How
- **Deliberation Summary:** Director How provided financial statements and a citywide update by district. Key project highlights included:
 - *The Point:* Economic development agreement in process, dependent on READI 2 funding.
 - *Muncie Mall Area Development:* In planning; dependent on READI 2 support to accelerate over \$100 million in private investment.
 - *Business Relocations & Housing:* Assisting local businesses with relocations, working on downtown market-rate apartments/hotel, senior housing, and 120-home and 39-home market-rate housing developments.
 - *Former YMCA:* Developer working through structural engineering and demolition challenges.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no board action taken.

00:22:51 00:46:28 Resolution / Adoption: Muncie East Corridor Revitalization Plan

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Director Jeff How / Presented as a tool/barrier-removal document for future grants.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Director How presented the Muncie East Corridor Revitalization Plan (covering McKinley, Gilbert, and Madison/Whiser streets), emphasizing it as a general framework/tool required to apply for revitalization grants rather than a binding project list. Board members debated the lack of community/neighborhood stakeholder engagement, factual errors/misidentifications within the text, and whether formal adoption was necessary without proper vetting.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Multiple residents criticized the lack of public engagement, noted factual/historical inaccuracies (such as misidentifying the Emily Kimbro House), and questioned the strategic value of adopting an unvetted document.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 3-2 (Roll call vote: Mr. Miller - Yes, Mr. Pavilla - Yes, Miss Waggley - Yes; Mr. Bishop - No, Mr. Dale - No).

00:48:38 Resolution 2025-01: 2026 TIFF Assessed Value Capture

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bob Swintz (London Witty Group)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Swintz presented the annual TIFF report submitted to the DLGF and introduced Resolution 2025-01, which informs the county auditor and taxing units of the commission's intent to capture 100% of the assessed value (TIFF proceeds) for 2026 to meet debt obligations and ongoing pay-as-you-go projects.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Motion carried unanimously on roll call).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:06:36 Miss Jameson:** Addressed the board regarding the East Central/McKinley plan, noting a massive communication gap where residents fear unannounced actions. Also inquired about the old Sports Plex property timeline with D.R. Horton and criticized the board's optics and treatment of free speech during the previous month's meeting.
- **01:09:53 Mr. Tucker:** Commented on the revitalization plan's executive summary, warning against potential stigmatization of the area based on low-income housing categorizations.
- **01:10:33 Kim Miller:** Spoke on behalf of neighborhood stakeholders regarding the newly adopted plan, pointing out factual errors (such as the misidentification of the Emily Kimbro House) and criticizing the lack of resident inclusion prior to adoption.
- **01:13:08 Brian Shaw:** Representing the East Central Neighborhood Association, stated the document reads more like an action-item list than a plan and urged the commission to communicate and partner directly with neighborhood association boards.
- **01:14:52 Christopher Bilbury:** Criticized the timing of board votes prior to public comment, the inadequacy of meeting minutes compared to city council standards, and

board decorum during public participation.

- **01:17:49 Rob Miller:** Noted his ongoing work restoring a vacant historic home in East Central Muncie, echoed concerns regarding the misidentification of historical landmarks in the revitalization plan, and urged the commission to correct factual errors before pitching to grantors.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Facade Grant Committee update provided by Mr. Bishop and Mr. Pavilla (Jason Phillips named chair; application form finalized).
 - Presentation delivered by Mike Genta regarding D.R. Horton's Storey Estates housing development (34 total lots, 16 sold, 21 available).
 - Update provided by Nate Howard on the Muncie Land Bank (transfer of properties, tax certificate assessments, and county commissioner rejection of countywide collaboration).
 - Presiding officer noted that the next regular meeting is scheduled for June 19th, which falls on a federal holiday, requiring potential calendar review and rescheduling.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting officially stood adjourned following the closing announcements.

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